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漢字 3: Flat (平)

平

平

Flat.

Extended meanings such as “ordinary and peaceful”.

∈ Composition

Glyphs	艹 + 干
English	Grass/Herb/Plant + Dry

▲ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Flat, [dried] [herbs].

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ヘイ (HEI)	ひら (hira)
ヘイ is the more common of these readings.		
L.C.	ビョウ (BYŌ)	たい (tai)

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

The flats <he rustled> went (HAYWIRE).

Flats in <Tailand> will (BE YOURS).

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
平たい	<i>flat; level</i>	ひらたい (hiratai)
平和	flat + harmony = <i>peace</i>	ヘイワ (HEIWA)
太平洋	fat + flat + ocean = <i>the Pacific Ocean</i>	タイヘイヨウ (TAIHEI-YŌ)

{...} Sample Sentence

平和	は	とても	大切	です。
ヘイワ	は	とても	タイセツ	です
peace	は	very	important	be/is
<i>Peace is of great importance.</i>				

漢字 4: Degree (度)

度

度

Degree. Extent.

This 漢字 can also mean “times” in the sense of “how many times”.

∈ Composition

Glyphs	广 + 廿 + 又ヌ
English	Slanted roof + Twenty + Again

▲ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

The extent of the [slanted roof] making a [20] degree angle [again].

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ド (DO)	たび (tabi)
L.C.	タク、ト (TAKU, TO)	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

The extent of <tubby> (DOTS) (TUCKED) at the (TOP).

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
度々	degree + degree = <i>often; over and over</i>	たびたび (tabitabi)
一度	one + degree (times) = <i>once; one time</i>	イチド (ICHI-DO)
丁度	block + degree = <i>exactly</i>	チョウド (CHŌDO)

{...} Sample Sentence

さあ、	もう一度。
さあ	もうイチド
come now	once more
<i>Come on, try again.</i>	

漢字 5: Edge (際)

Edge. Limit.

A secondary meaning has to do with “occasion”.

∈ Composition

Glyphs 冨 阜 + 祭

English Hill/Mound + Festival (??)

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

At the edge of the [hill] a [festival] was held.

♪ Pronunciations

音読み

訓読み

Cm. サイ (SAI)

きわ (kiwa)

The 訓読み is always voice outside the first position with the exception of 一際 (hitokiwa/ひと・きわ), “*remarkably, conspicuous*”; recall from Entry ?? that no 漢字 becomes voiced following 一 when it is read with its 訓読み of ひと (hito).

L.C.

—

—

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Edgy (PSYCHO) <key-warden>.

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
水際	water + edge = <i>water's edge;</i> <i>waterside</i>	みずぎわ (mizu-giwa)
国際	country + edge = <i>international</i>	コク・サイ (KOKU-SAI)
実際	actual + edge = <i>in</i> <i>practice; in actuality</i>	ジッ・サイ (JISSAI)

{...} Sample Sentence

英語	は	国際語	に	成った。
エイゴ	は	コクサイゴ	に	なった
English	は	international language	に	to become
<i>English has become an international language.</i>				

漢字 6: Lend (貸)

Lend.

∈ Composition

Glyphs 代 + 貝

English Substitute (??) + Shellfish

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Lending [shellfish] to the [substitute].

♪ Pronunciations

音読み

訓読み

Cm. —

か (ka)

L.C. タイ (TAI)

—

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Lending to <customers> is really a <TIGHT> spot.

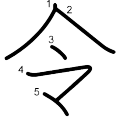
+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
As the last two examples show, this 漢字 can absorb its ひらがな accompaniment when forming compounds. This reading is also frequently voiced when not in the first position.		
貸す	<i>lend</i>	かす (kasu)
貸切	lend + cut = <i>reserved;</i> <i>chartered</i>	かしきり (kashikiri)
貸主	lend + primary = <i>lender; landlord</i>	かしぬし (kashinushi)

{...} Sample Sentence

金	を	貸して	友	を	失え。
キン	を	かして	とも	を	うしなえ
gold	を	to lend	friend	を	to lose
<i>Lend your money and lose your friend.</i>					

漢字 7: Command (令)

		
Command. Order.		
This 漢字 is also used as an honorific prefix in certain compounds.		

∈ Composition	
Glyphs	亼 + 卩
English	Assembly/Gathering + Seal/Stamp

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
Command the [assembly] to give their [stamp] of approval.

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	レイ (REI)	—
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Command it to start **RAINING**.

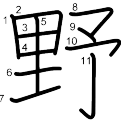
+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
指令	finger + command = <i>order; directive</i>	シ・レイ (SHI-REI)
号令	title + command = <i>command; order</i>	ゴウ・レイ (GŌ-REI)

{...} Sample Sentence

私	の	命令	は	絶対	だ。
わたし	の	メイレイ	は	ゼツタイ	だ
I	の	orders	は	absolute	be/is
<i>My orders are absolute.</i>					

漢字 8: Field (野)

		
Field. The wild.		
Interestingly, this 漢字 is used to denote a “political party in opposition”.		

∈ Composition	
Glyphs	里 + 予
English	Hamlet + Beforehand (??)

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
Fields in the [hamlet] must be watered [beforehand].

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ヤ (YA)	の (no)
This is a tougher character than might be expected; both readings will be encountered frequently, although ヤ appears more often in the second position.		
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

In the wild **YACHTING** with the <nobs>.

*Yob is a rude, noisy, and aggressive young person.

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
野心	field + heart = <i>ambition</i>	ヤ・シン (YA-SHIN)
分野	part + field = <i>field</i> (of study, etc.)	ブン・ヤ (BUN-YA)
野原	field + original = <i>field(s)</i>	nohara (のほら)

{...} Sample Sentence

彼	は	大変な	野心家	だった。
かれ	は	タイヘンな	ヤシンカ	だった
he	は	immense	ambitious person	だった
<i>He was a man of great ambition.</i>				

漢字 9: Wide (広)

広	広	
---	---	--

Wide. Broad. Spacious.

∈ Composition

Glyphs	广 + 厶
English	Slanted roof + Self/Private

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

The wide	[slanted roof] is [private].
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♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	コウ (KŌ)	ひろ (hiro)
L.C.	—	—

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Wide open, <Hiroshima> was its own <CAUSE> of defeat.

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
広い	<i>wide; spacious</i>	ひろい (hiroī)
広島	wide + island = <i>Hiroshima</i>	ひろしま (hiroshima)
広大	wide + large = <i>extensive; immense</i>	コウダイ (KŌ-DAI)

{...} Sample Sentence

その	川	は	広い。
その	かわ	は	ひろい
that/the	river	は	wide
<i>The river is wide.</i>			

漢字 10: Stone (石)

石	石	
---	---	--

Stone.

∈ Composition

Glyphs	石
English	Stone/Rock

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Part of the 漢字 radicals (#112).

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	セキ (SEKI)	いし (ishi)
Both readings are used frequently in compounds, although セキ is more common outside of the first position.		
L.C.	シャク、コク (SHAKU, KOKU)	—

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

The stone-colored <Ishihara> test that <COCKED> my interest was <SHOCKINGLY> <SEXY>.

+ Words and Compounds

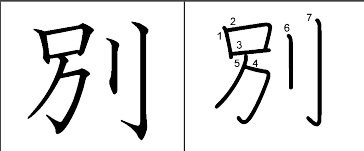
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
石	<i>stone</i>	いし (ishi)
化石	change + stone = <i>fossil</i>	カセキ (KASEKI)
一石二鳥	one + stone + two + bird = <i>kill two birds with one stone</i>	イッセキニチョウ (ISSEKINI-CHŌ)

{...} Sample Sentence

橋	は	石造り	だ
はし	は	いしづくり	だ
bridge	は	made of stone	だ
<i>The bridge is made of stone.</i>			

漢字 11: China (漢)		
		
China. The Han Dynasty.		
	∈ Composition	
Glyphs	水 艹 + 𠂔 + 口 + 夫	
English	Water + Grass/Herb/Plant + Mouth + Husband (??)	
♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components		
Chinese [vampire] [husbands] drink [water] mixed with [herbs].		
	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	カン (KAN)	—
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations		
The Chinese are <CUNNING>.		
+ Words and Compounds		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
漢字	China + character = 漢字	カン・ジ (KAN-JI)
漢方	China + direction = Chinese medicine	カン・ポウ (KAN-PŌ)
{...} Sample Sentence		
この	漢字	は どういう 意味 です か。
この	カンジ	は どういう イミ です か
this	Kanji	は what kind of meaning be/is か
What does this kanji mean?		

漢字 12: Different (別)		
		
Different.		
The ideas of Separation and Farewell.		
	∈ Composition	
Glyphs	口 + 勹 + 𠂔刀 刀	
English	Mouth + Embracing/Wrap + Knife/Sword	
♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components		
Different	[vampires] [embraced] the idea of a [sword]	
farewell	.	
	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ベツ (BETSU)	わか (waka)
L.C.	—	わ (wa)

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations		
Different <wanderers> made <wakaberry> <(BETS)>.		
+ Words and Compounds		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
別れる	part company; branch off	わかれる (wakareru)
別々	different + different = separate; individual	ベツ・ベツ (BETSU・BETSU)
送別	send + different = farewell; send-off	ソウ・ベツ (SŌ・BETSU)
{...} Sample Sentence		
別々	に	払います。
ベツベツ	に	はらいます
separately	に	to pay
Please bill us separately.		

漢字 13: Garden (園)

Garden.

∈ Composition

Glyphs 口 + 土 + 口 + 衣衤

English Prison/Enclosure + Earth/Soil + Mouth + Clothes

Long kimono | 袁 = 衣 + 口 + 土

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

The garden was a [soil] [enclosure] for [clothed] [vampires].

♪ Pronunciations

音読み

訓読み

Cm. エン (EN)

—

L.C. —

その (sono)

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Garden <ENTRANCE> graced with <sonorous> sounds.

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
Recall from Entry ?? that the first two characters of the final compound mean “animal” when taken together.		
公園	public + garden = <i>park</i>	コウ.エン (KŌ-EN)
学園	study + garden = <i>educational institute</i>	ガク.エン (GAKU-EN)
動物園	animal + garden = <i>zoo</i>	ドウ.ブツ.エン (DŌ-BUTSU-EN)

{...} Sample Sentence

公園	で	降りました。
コウエン	で	おりました
park	で	descend
<i>I got off at the park.</i>		

漢字 14: All (皆)

All.

∈ Composition

Glyphs 比 + 白

English Compare (??) + White

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

All [white] [comparisons].

♪ Pronunciations

音読み

訓読み

Cm. —

みな (mina)

In spoken Japanese, this reading is often pronounced
みんな (minna) for emphasis.

L.C. カイ (KAI)

—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

All <minatory> <KITES>.

*Minatory expresses or conveys a threat.

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
皆	<i>all; everybody</i>	みな (mina)
皆様	all + manner = “ladies and gentlemen”	みな.さま (minasama)

{...} Sample Sentence

皆	幸せ	だ。
みんな	しあわせ	だ
everyone	happiness	be/is
<i>All are happy.</i>		

漢字 15: Immediate (即)

即	即	
Immediate. At once.		

∈ Composition

Glyphs	卩 + 艮
English	Seal/Stamp + Boundary

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Immediately	[stop] at the [boundary].
-------------	---------------------------

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ソク (SOKU)	—
L.C.	—	—

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Immediately	, the <SOKKIE> came to an end.
-------------	--------------------------------

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
即日	immediate + sun (day) = <i>on the same day</i>	ソク・ジツ (SOKU-JITSU)
即死	immediate + death = <i>instant death</i>	ソク・シ (SOKU-SHI)
即売	immediate + sell = <i>sale on the spot</i>	ソク・バイ (SOKU-BAI)

{...} Sample Sentence

その	犬	は	即死した。
その	いぬ	は	ソクシした
that	dog	は	instant death
<i>The dog was killed on the spot.</i>			

漢字 16: Shop (店)

店	店	
Shop. Store.		

∈ Composition

Glyphs	广 + 占
English	Slanted Roof + Occupy

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Shops	with [slanted roofs] are [occupied] by the American military.
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♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	テン (TEN)	みせ (mise)
テン is the more common reading.		
L.C.	—	—

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

The shop	was filled with <TENSE> <misery>.
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+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
店	<i>shop; store</i>	みせ (mise)
開店	open + shop = <i>shop/store opening</i>	カイ・テン (KAI-TEN)
書店	write + shop = <i>bookstore</i>	ショ・テン (SHO-TEN)

{...} Sample Sentence

書店	で	手	に	入ります。
ショテン	で	て	に	はいります
bookstore	で	hand	に	to get in
<i>You can get it at a bookstore.</i>				

漢字 17: Institution (院)

Institution, in the sense of public buildings such as hospitals, or bodies such as legislatures.

∈ Composition

Glyphs	阝 阜 + 完
English	Hill/Mound + Perfect

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Institution [perfectly] situated on a [hill].

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	イン (IN)	—
L.C.	—	—

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Institution for (INK).

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
入院	enter + institution = <i>to be admitted to hospital</i>	ニュウ・イン (NYŪIN)
学院	study + institution = <i>academy</i>	ガク・イン (GAKUIN)
病院	illness + institution = <i>hospital</i>	ビョウ・イン (BYŌIN)

{...} Sample Sentence

病院	は	ここ	から	近い。
ビョウイン	は	ここ	から	ちかい
hospital	は	here	from	near
<i>The hospital is near here.</i>				

漢字 18: Climb (登)

Climb.

An important secondary meaning has to do with attendance (the first compound offers an example).

∈ Composition

Glyphs	𡳚 + 豆
English	Footsteps/Departure + Bean/A kind of a vessel

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Climb after your [departure] into a [kind of a vessel].

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	トウ (TŌ)	—
L.C.	ト (TO)	のぼ (nobo)

You are likely to encounter the 音読み in one word: 登山 (ト・ザン/TOZAN) “*mountain climbing*”, with 山 being voiced. The 訓読み for this 漢字 serves as an alternate form of 上る (のぼる/noboru), which we met in Entry ??.

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Climbing is (TORTURE) when there is <nobody> at the (TOP) to help you.

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
登校	climb (attend) + school = <i>attend school</i>	トウ・コウ (TŌKŌ)
登場	climb + place = <i>make an entrance; show up</i>	トウ・ジョウ (TŌJŌ)

{...} Sample Sentence

登校する	所	です。
トウコウする	ところ	です
going to school	place	be/is
<i>I am going to school.</i>		

漢字 19: Original (原)

Original, in the sense of things in their “original or primitive state”.

Many compounds with this character also convey the idea of a “plain or field” (the first two examples below, for instance). Think of this in connection to original as a place that is “unspoiled or wilderness-like”.

∈ Composition

Glyphs	厂 + 白 + 小
English	Cliff + White + Small

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

The original	[white], [small] [cliff].
--------------	---------------------------

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ゲン (GEN)	はら (hara)
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Originally, <GENGHIS-KHAN> committed <hara-kiri>.

** Irregular Reading(s)

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
川原	river + original = <i>dry riverbed</i>	かわら (kawara)

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
野原	field + original = <i>field(s)</i>	のほら (nohara)
高原	tall + original = <i>plateau; tableland</i>	コウ・ゲン (KŌ-GEN)
原子力	original + child + strength = <i>atomic energy; nuclear power</i>	ゲン・シ・リョク (GENSHIRYOKU)

{...} Sample Sentence

野原	に	は	六	頭	の	羊	が	いた。
のほら	に	は	ロク	トウ	の	ひつじ	が	いた
field	に	は	six	counter for large animals	の	sheep	が	to be
There were six sheep in the field.								

漢字 20: Late (晩)

Late, Evening.

This 漢字 also imparts the idea of late in a number of more poetic words—the first two compounds below offer examples.

∈ Composition

Glyphs	日 + 免
English	Sun/Clear + Exemption

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

The late-evening	[sun] was [exempted] from the rest of the [day].
------------------	--

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	バン (BAN)	—
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Late	<BUNNIES>.
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+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
晩秋	late + autumn = <i>late autumn</i>	バン・シュウ (BAN-SHŪ)
晩年	late + year = <i>one's later years</i>	バン・ネン (BAN-NEN)
今晚は	now + late = “good evening”	コン・バン・は (KON-BAN-wa)

{...} Sample Sentence

ブラウン	氏	は	晩年	に	入っ てい る。
ブラウン	シ	は	バンネン	に	はいっ てい る
Braun	Mr	は	last years	に	to get in
Mr Brown is in the sunset of his life.					

漢字 21: Entwine (絡)

絡	絡	
Entwine. Become entangled.		

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	糸 + 各
English	Thread + Each (??)

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components	
Entwine	[each] [thread].

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ラク (RAKU)	から (kara)
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Entangled with <caramel> (LUCKILY).

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
絡む	<i>entwine; become entangled</i>	からむ (karamu)
絡み付く	<i>entwine + attach = cling to; coil around</i>	からみ つく (karami tsuku)
短絡	<i>short + entwine = short circuit</i>	タン・ラク (TAN-RAKU)

{...} Sample Sentence

此の	つる草	は	木	に	絡みつきます。
この	つるソウ	は	き	に	からみつきます
this	vine	は	tree	に	to twine around
<i>This vine winds around trees.</i>					

漢字 22: Express (表)

表	表	
Express one's feelings and beliefs, etc. This idea of bringing things into the open extends to this 漢字's other primary meanings, namely "surfaces and charts".		

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	主 + 衣衤
English	Primary ?? + Clothing

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components	
Express	your feelings about the [primary] school's [clothing].

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ヒョウ (HYŌ)	おもて、あらわ (omote, arawa)

ヒョウ is the more common of these readings. あらわ forms the two verbs in the second and third examples below; you may recognize these as being pronounced identically to 現れる and 現す from Entry ???. Not surprisingly, the pair here can also be seen written at times as 表われる and 表わす. Though these characters are similar in some respects, this 漢字 is used more for the idea of *expressing* things such as feelings, thoughts, and opinions.

L.C.	—	—
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♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Expressions of <YAWNING> when <commotions> go on in the <Arawaks>.

‡Arawaks are indigenous people of South America.

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
表	<i>surface; front</i>	おもて (omote)
表れる (intr.)	<i>be expressed</i>	あらわれる (arawareru)
表す (tr.)	<i>express; reveal</i>	あらわす (arawasu)
表現	<i>express + present = expression</i>	ヒョウ・ゲン (HYŌ-GEN)

{...} Sample Sentence

思想	は	言葉	で	表現される。
シソウ	は	ことば	で	ヒョウゲンさせる
thought	は	words	で	expression
<i>Thoughts are expressed by means of words.</i>				

漢字 23: Type (式)

The primary meaning is that of a “type or style” of something (as in the second compound). It is also very commonly used, however, in the sense of “ceremony” (as is evident in the final example). Take care with the stroke order of this 漢字.	

Composition	
Glyphs	弋 + 工
English	Shoot + Work/Craft

Meaning ↔ Glyph Components	
Type	of [shooting ceremony] for prosperous [work and crafts].

Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	シキ (SHIKI)	—
L.C.	—	—

Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Type	of (SHEIKH).
‡Sheikh refers to a Muslim religious scholar.	

+ Words and Compounds		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
形式	form + type = <i>form</i> ; <i>formality</i>	ケイ・シキ (KEISHIKI)
自動式	self + move + type = <i>automatic</i>	ジ・ドウ・シキ (JIDŌSHIKI)
成人式	become + person + type = <i>Coming of Age ceremony</i>	セイ・ジン・セキ (SEIJINSHIKI)

{...} Sample Sentence				
朝食	は	バイキング	形式	だった。
チョウ シヨク	は	バイキング	ケイシキ	だった
breakfast	は	smorgasbord	form	だった
<i>Breakfast is a smorgasbord.</i>				

漢字 24: Passage (通)

The general concept is of “passing through and along”. This is a very versatile 漢字 that can mean a variety of things, from “street” (it often appears on road signs), to the ideas of “thoroughly getting to know a subject” or “having things go according to plan”.	

Composition	
Glyphs	マ + 用 + 辵
English	MA katakana + Utilize + Road/Walk

Meaning ↔ Glyph Components	
Passage	[utilizes] a [road] for [mother] to [walk] on.

Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ツウ (TSŪ)	とお (tō)
In the first position, ツウ is by far the more common reading. Both occur frequently in the second position, and the 訓読み is often voiced (although is never becomes so when forming verbs).		
L.C.	ツ (TSU)	かよ (kayo)

Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

The passage	to (TSUU'TINA) was <tormenting> because of the (TSUNAMI) <knockout>.
‡Tsuu'Tina is an indigenous group in Alberta, Canada.	

+ Words and Compounds		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
通る (intr.)	<i>go along; pass by</i>	とおる (tōru)
通す (tr.)	<i>pierce; let through</i>	とおす (tōsu)
大通り	large + passage = <i>a main street</i>	おお どおり (ō dōri)
交通	mix + passage = <i>traffic;</i> <i>communication</i>	コウ・ツウ (KŌ-TSŪ)

{...} Sample Sentence		
交通量	が	少なかった。
コウツウリョウ	が	すくなかった
traffic	が	few
<i>There wasn't much traffic.</i>		

漢字 25: Past (昨)

昨	昨	
Past.		

∈ Composition		
Glyphs	日 + 乍	
English	Sun/Clear + Although/While	

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components		
The past, [though], is [clear].		

♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	サク (SAKU)	—
L.C.	—	—

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations		
The past really (SUCKS) hey.		

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
昨年	past + year = <i>last year</i>	サク・ネン (SAKU-NEN)
昨夜	past + night = <i>last night</i>	サク・ヤ (SAKU-YA)
昨今	past + now = <i>recently; nowadays</i>	サッ・コン (SAK-KON)

** Irregular Reading(s)

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
昨日	past + sun (day) = <i>yesterday</i>	きのう (kinō)

This compound can also be read using the character's normal onyomi (サク・ジツ/SAKU-JITSU), giving the word a more formal tone.

{...} Sample Sentence

昨日	は	寒かった。
きのう	は	さむかった
yesterday	は	cold
<i>It was cold yesterday.</i>		

漢字 26: Bundle (束)

束	束	
---	---	--

Bundle. Bunch.

Note that the writing order of this 漢字 does not follow the components as listed above, with “mouth” written after the initial horizontal stroke. It is similar in this respect to the character for *East* (東) from Entry ??.

∈ Composition		
Glyphs	木 + 口	
English	Tree + Mouth	

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components		
Bunch of [vampires] forming bundles of [wood] from the [tree].		

♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ソク (SOKU)	たば (taba)
L.C.	—	つか (tsuka)

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

A bundle of <tsukas> were sent to <Thaba'NChu> in a (SOCK).

‡Thaba'NChu is a town in Free State, South Africa.

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
束	<i>bundle; bunch</i>	たば (taba)
花束	flower + bunch = <i>bouquet</i>	はなたば (hanataba)
結束	bind + bunch = <i>union; combination</i>	ケッ・ソク (KESSOKU)

{...} Sample Sentence

約束	は	約束。
ヤクソク	は	ヤクソク
promise	は	promise
<i>A promise is a promise.</i>		

漢字 27: Special (特)

特	特	
Special.		

	∈ Composition	
Glyphs	牛 + 寺	
English	Cow + Temple	

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components	
Special	「cow」 「temples」.

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	トク (TOKU)	—
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Special	〈TALK〉-shows.
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+ Words and Compounds		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
特別	special + different = <i>special; extraordinary</i>	トクベツ (TOKU-BETSU)
特売	special + sell = <i>bargain; special buy</i>	トクバイ (TOKU-BAI)
特急	special + hasten = <i>special express (train)</i>	トクキュウ (TOKU-KYŪ)

{...} Sample Sentence			
特別	いい	気分	だ。
トクベツ	いい	キブン	だ
special	good	feeling	be / is
<i>I feel just fine.</i>			

漢字 28: True (真)

真	真	
True. Genuine.		

This 漢字 often intensifies the quality of the character that follows it. The irregular readings and the first compound below offer examples of this.

	∈ Composition	
Glyphs	十 + 具	
English	Ten + Tool (??)	

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components		
True	「cross」	「tool」.

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	シン (SHIN)	ま (ma)
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations
Truth 〈SHEENS〉 through the <mucky>, <muddy> lies.

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
真新しい	true + new = <i>brand-new</i>	ま あたらしい (ma atarashii)
真実	true + actual = <i>truth; reality</i>	シンジツ (SHIN-JITSU)

** Irregular Reading(s)

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
真赤	true + red = <i>deep red</i>	まっか (makka)
真青	true + blue = <i>deep blue</i>	まっさお (massao)

These are the only two words in which the readings of the 漢字 that follow 真 change in such a radical way. More common examples include 真白 (masshiro/まっしろ) *snow white* and 真暗 (makkura/まっくら) *pitch dark*. You may also see these compounds written as 真っ赤, 真っ青, 真っ白 and 真っ暗. Keep an eye out as well for a few words such as 真中 (まんなか/mannaka) *right in the middle*, which is also sometimes written as 真ん中.

{...} Sample Sentence				
この	物語	は	真実	です。
この	ものがたり	は	シンジツ	です
this	story	は	truth	be/is
<i>This story is true.</i>				

漢字 29: Office (局)

局

局

Office. Bureau.

In a few words this 漢字 can also mean *the situation*, or *state of something* (the first compound is an example).

∈ Composition

Glyphs	尸 + 口 + 勹
English	Corpse/Body + Mouth + Embrace/Wrap

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

The bureau of [vampires] [partly wrapped] the [corpse bodies].

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	キョク (KYOKU)	—
L.C.	—	—

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Office of (KYOKUSHIN) karate.

‡Kyokushin karate was founded in 1964 by Korean-Japanese Masutatsu Oyama.

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
結局	bind + office (situation) = <i>after all; in the long run</i>	ケツ・キョク (KEK-KYOKU)
水道局	water supply system + office = <i>water bureau</i>	スイ・ドウ・キョク (SUI-DŌ-KYOKU)
薬局	medicine + office = <i>pharmacy</i>	ヤッ・キョク (YAK-KYOKU)

{...} Sample Sentence

一番近い 薬局 は どこ に あります か。

イチバン ヤッ ちかい キョク は どこ に あります か

closest pharmacy は where に to be か

Where's the nearest drugstore?

漢字 30: Gather (集)

集

集

Gather. Assemble.

∈ Composition

Glyphs	隹 + 木
English	Old birds + Tree

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Gathering [old birds] in the [tree].

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	シュウ (SHŪ)	あつ (atsu)
L.C.	—	つど (tsudo)

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Gather at the <atsumori> play with our (SHOES) on and <stew dough>.

‡The Atsumori play focuses on a young samurai killed in the Genpei War.

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
集まる (intr.)	<i>gather; come together</i>	あつ・まる (atsu-maru)
集める (tr.)	<i>gather; collect (sth.)</i>	あつ・める (atsu-meru)
集中	gather + middle = <i>concentration</i>	シュウ・チュウ (SHŪ-CHŪ)

{...} Sample Sentence

私 は 読書 に 集中した。

わたし は ドクショ に シュウチュウ した

I は reading に concentrate

I was concentrating on reading.